

Overview

Related formats

Example

Properties

vCard	
<u>Filename extension</u>	.vcf, .vcard
<u>Internet media type</u>	text/vcard
<u>Type code</u>	vCard
<u>Uniform Type Identifier (UTI)</u>	public.vcard
<u>Developed by</u>	Created by <u>Versit Consortium</u> , all rights transferred in 1996 to <u>Internet Mail Consortium</u> , all rights transferred in 2004 to CalConnect
<u>Type of format</u>	<u>Electronic business card</u>
<u>Container for</u>	Contact information
<u>Standard</u>	RFC 6350 (https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc6350)

Name	Property presence			Description	Example
	v. 2.1 ^[2]	v. 3.0	v. 4.0		
ADR	Optional	Optional	Optional	A structured representation of the physical delivery address for the vCard object.	ADR;TYPE=home;;;123 Main St.;Springfield,IL;12345;USA
AGENT	Optional	Optional	Undefined	Information about another person who will act on behalf of the vCard object. Typically this would be an area administrator, assistant, or secretary for the individual. Can be either a URL or an embedded vCard.	AGENT:http://mi6.gov.uk/007
ANNIVERSARY	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	Defines the person's anniversary.	ANNIVERSARY:19901021
BDAY	Optional	Optional	Optional	Date of birth of the individual associated with the vCard.	BDAY:19700310
BEGIN	Required	Required	Required	All vCards must start with this property.	BEGIN:VCARD
CALADRURI	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	A URL to use for sending a scheduling request to the person's calendar.	CALADRURI:http://example.com/calendar/jdoe
CALURI	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	A URL to the person's calendar.	CALURI:http://example.com/calendar/jdoe
CATEGORIES	Undefined	Optional	Optional	A list of "tags" that can be used to describe the object represented by this vCard.	CATEGORIES:swimmer,biker
CLASS	Undefined	Optional	Undefined	Describes the sensitivity of the information in the vCard.	CLASS:public
CLIENTPIDMAP	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	Used for synchronizing different revisions of the same vCard.	CLIENTPIDMAP:1;urn:uuid:3df403f4-5924-4bb7-b077-3c711d9eb34b
EMAIL	Optional	Optional	Optional	The address for electronic mail communication with the vCard object.	EMAIL:johndoe@hotmail.com
END	Required	Required	Required	All vCards must end with this property.	END:VCARD
FBURL	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	Defines a URL that shows when the person is "free" or "busy" on their calendar.	FBURL:http://example.com/fb/jdoe
FN	Optional	Required	Required	The formatted name string associated with the vCard object.	FN:Dr. John Doe
GENDER	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	Defines the person's gender.	GENDER:F
GEO	Optional	Optional	Optional	Specifies a latitude and longitude.	2.1, 3.0: GEO:39.95;−75.1667 4.0: GEO:geo:39.95,−75.1667 (geo:39.95,−75.1667)
IMPP	Undefined	Maybe	Optional	Defines an instant messenger handle. This property was introduced in a separate RFC when the latest vCard version was 3.0. Therefore, 3.0 vCards might use this property without otherwise declaring it.	IMPP:aim:johndoe@aol.com
KEY	Optional	Optional	Optional	The public encryption key associated with the vCard object. It may point to an external URL, may be plain text, or may be embedded in the vCard as a Base64 encoded block of text.	2.1: KEY;PGP:http://example.com/key.pgp 2.1: KEY;PGP;ENCODING=BASE64:[base64-data] 3.0: KEY;TYPE=PGP:http://example.com/key.pgp 3.0: KEY;TYPE=PGP;ENCODING=b:[base64-data] 4.0: KEY;MEDIATYPE=application/pgp-keys:http://example.com/key.pgp 4.0: KEY:data:application/pgp-keys;base64,[base64-data]
KIND	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	Defines the type of entity that this vCard represents: 'application', 'individual', 'group', 'location' or 'organization'; 'x-*' values may be used for experimental purposes. ^{[3][4]}	KIND:individual
LABEL	Optional	Optional	Incorporated without	Represents the actual text that should be put on the mailing label when delivering a physical package to the person/object associated with the vCard (related to the ADR property). Not supported in version 4.0. Instead, this information is stored in the LABEL parameter of the ADR property. Example: ADR;TYPE=home;LABEL="123 Main St\nNew York, NY 12345";;123 Main St;New	LABEL;TYPE=HOME:123 Main St.\nSpringfield, IL 12345\nUSA

Name	Property presence			Description	Example
	v. 2.1 ^[2]	v. 3.0	v. 4.0		
				York;NY;12345;USA	
LANG	Mentioned ^{[2]:34}	Undefined	Optional	Defines a language that the person speaks.	LANG:fr-CA
LOGO	Optional	Optional	Optional	An image or graphic of the logo of the organization that is associated with the individual to which the vCard belongs. It may point to an external URL or may be embedded in the vCard as a Base64 encoded block of text.	2.1: LOGO;PNG:http://example.com/logo.png 2.1: LOGO;PNG;ENCODING=BASE64: [base64-data] 3.0: LOGO;TYPE=PNG:http://example.com/logo.png 3.0: LOGO;TYPE=PNG;ENCODING=b: [base64-data] 4.0: LOGO;MEDIATYPE=image/png:http://example.com/logo.png 4.0: LOGO;ENCODING=BASE64;TYPE=PNG: [base64-data]
MAILER	Optional	Optional	Undefined	Type of email program used.	MAILER:Thunderbird
MEMBER	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	Defines a member that is part of the group that this vCard represents. Acceptable values include: - a "mailto:" URL containing an email address - a UID which references the member's own vCard The KIND property must be set to "group" in order to use this property.	MEMBER:urn:uuid:03a0e51f-d1aa-4385-8a53-e29025acd8af
N	Required	Required	Optional	A structured representation of the name of the person, place or thing associated with the vCard object. Structure recognizes, in order separated by semicolons: Family Name, Given Name, Additional/Middle Names, Honorific Prefixes, and Honorific Suffixes ^[5]	N:Doe;John;;Dr;
NAME	Undefined	Optional	Undefined	Provides a textual representation of the SOURCE property.	
NICKNAME	Undefined	Optional	Optional	One or more descriptive/familiar names for the object represented by this vCard.	NICKNAME:Jon,Johnny
NOTE	Optional	Optional	Optional	Specifies supplemental information or a comment that is associated with the vCard.	NOTE:I am proficient in Tiger-Crane Style, \nand I am more than proficient in the exquisite art of the Samurai sword.
ORG	Optional	Optional	Optional	The name and optionally the unit(s) of the organization associated with the vCard object. This property is based on the X.520 Organization Name attribute and the X.520 Organization Unit attribute.	ORG:Google;GMail Team;Spam Detection Squad
PHOTO	Optional	Optional	Optional	An image or photograph of the individual associated with the vCard. It may point to an external URL or may be embedded in the vCard as a Base64 encoded block of text.	2.1: PHOTO;JPEG:http://example.com/photo.jpg 2.1: PHOTO;JPEG;ENCODING=BASE64: [base64-data] 3.0: PHOTO;TYPE=JPEG;VALUE=URI:http://example.com/photo.jpg 3.0: PHOTO;TYPE=JPEG;ENCODING=b: [base64-data] 4.0: PHOTO;MEDIATYPE=image/jpeg:http://example.com/photo.jpg 4.0: PHOTO:data:image/jpeg;base64, [base64-data] ^[6]
PROID	Undefined	Optional	Optional	The identifier for the product that created the vCard object.	PROID:-//ONLINE DIRECTORY//NONSGML Version 1//EN
PROFILE	Undefined	Optional	Undefined	States that the vCard is a vCard.	PROFILE:VCARD
RELATED	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	Another entity that the person is related to. Acceptable values include: - a "mailto:" URL containing an email address - a UID which references the person's own vCard - a text value used to specify textual information	RELATED;TYPE=friend:urn:uuid:03a0e51f-d1aa-4385-8a53-e29025acd8af
REV	Optional	Optional	Optional	A timestamp for the last time the vCard was updated.	REV:20121201T134211Z
ROLE	Optional	Optional	Optional	The role, occupation, or business category of the vCard object within an organization.	ROLE:Executive
SORT-STRING	Undefined	Optional	Incorporated without	Defines a string that should be used when an application sorts this vCard in some way. Not supported in version 4.0. Instead, this information is stored in the SORT-AS	SORT-STRING:Doe

Name	Property presence			Description	Example
	v. 2.1 ^[2]	v. 3.0	v. 4.0		
				parameter of the N and/or ORG properties.	
SOUND	Optional	Optional	Optional	By default, if this property is not grouped with other properties it specifies the pronunciation of the FN property of the vCard object. It may point to an external URL or may be embedded in the vCard as a Base64 encoded block of text.	2.1: SOUND;OGG:http://example.com/sound.ogg 2.1: SOUND;OGG;ENCODING=BASE64:[base64-data] 3.0: SOUND;TYPE=OGG:http://example.com/sound.ogg 3.0: SOUND;TYPE=OGG;ENCODING=b:[base64-data] 4.0: SOUND;MEDIATYPE=audio/ogg:http://example.com/sound.ogg 4.0: SOUND:data:audio/ogg;base64,[base64-data]
SOURCE	Undefined	Optional	Optional	A URL that can be used to get the latest version of this vCard.	SOURCE:http://johndoe.com/vcard.vcf
TEL	Optional	Optional	Optional	The canonical number string for a telephone number for telephony communication with the vCard object.	TEL;TYPE=cell:(123) 555-5832
TITLE	Optional	Optional	Optional	Specifies the job title, functional position or function of the individual associated with the vCard object within an organization.	TITLE:V.P. Research and Development
TZ	Optional	Optional	Optional	The time zone of the vCard object.	2.1, 3.0: TZ:-0500 4.0: TZ:America/New_York
UID	Optional	Optional	Optional	Specifies a value that represents a persistent, globally unique identifier associated with the object.	UID:urn:uuid:da418720-3754-4631-a169-db89a02b831b
URL	Optional	Optional	Optional	A URL pointing to a website that represents the person in some way. Default = "homepage"	URL;TITLE:https://www.johndoe.com
VERSION	Required	Required	Required	The version of the vCard specification. In version 4.0, this must come right after the BEGIN property.	VERSION:3.0
XML	Undefined	Undefined	Optional	Any XML data that is attached to the vCard. This is used if the vCard was encoded in XML (xCard standard) and the XML document contained elements which are not part of the xCard standard.	XML:Not an xCard XML element

See also

- CardDAV
- FOAF (ontology)
- Geo URI scheme

References

- RFC 6350, section 10.1 "Media Type Registration"
- "vCard version 2.1 Specification" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20150921154105/http://www.imc.org/pdi/vcard-21.rtf>). *Internet Mail Consortium*. versit. 1996-09-18. Archived from the original (<http://www.imc.org/pdi/vcard-21.rtf>) on 21 September 2015. Retrieved 2024-08-31.
- "vCard Format Specification: 6.1.4. KIND" (<https://tools.ietf.org/html/rfc6350#section-6.1.4>). IETF. August 2011.
- "vCard KIND:application" (<https://tools.ietf.org/html/rfc6473>). IETF. December 2011.
- Dawson, Frank; Howes, Tim (September 1998). "RFC 2426: vCard MIME Directory, section 3.1.2" (<https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc2426#section-3.1.2>).
- RFC 6350 § 6.2.4, datatracker.ietf.org, <https://datatracker.ietf.org/doc/html/rfc6350#section-6.2.4>

External links

- vCard 4.0 (<https://devguide.calconnect.org/vCard/vcard-4/>) at its developer CalConnect
- RFC 6350 (<https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc6350>) describing the vCard format version 4
- RFC 2426 (<https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc2426>) describing the vCard format version 3
- vCard and vCalendar (<https://web.archive.org/web/20150906130553/http://www.imc.org/pdi/>) (old versions) from the Internet Mail Consortium in the Internet Archive

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